

Chapter 3

Algorithms

Section 3.1 : Algorithms

Algorithms

- ▶ An *algorithm* is a finite sequence of precise instructions for performing a computation or for solving a problem.
- ▶ *Pseudocodes* are used to generalize any algorithm across different programming languages.
 - ▶ Provides an intermediate step between an English language description of an algorithm and an implementation of this algorithm in a programming language.



Properties of Algorithms

- ▶ **Input** : An algorithm has input values from a specified set.
- ▶ **Output** : From each set of input values an algorithm produces output values from a specified set. The output values are the solutions to the problem.
- ▶ **Definiteness** : The steps of an algorithm must be defined precisely.
- ▶ **Finiteness** : An algorithm should produce the desired output after a finite (but perhaps large) number of steps for any input in the set.
- ▶ **Effectiveness** : It must be possible to perform each step of an algorithm exactly and in a finite amount of time.
- ▶ **Generality** : The procedure should be applicable for all problems of the desired form, not just for a particular set of input values.



Searching Algorithms

- ▶ The task of locating an element in an ordered list in different contexts are called **searching problems**.
 - ▶ For instance, a program that checks the spelling of words searches for them in a dictionary, which is just an ordered list of words.
- ▶ Searching Algorithms:
 - ▶ Linear Search
 - ▶ Binary Search



Searching Algorithms (Contd.)

- ▶ Linear Search:
 - ▶ **INPUT**: An ordered list of elements.
 - ▶ **OUTPUT**: Index of the desired element in the list (if found).

ALGORITHM 2 The Linear Search Algorithm.

procedure *linear search*(x : integer, $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$: distinct integers)

$i := 1$

while ($i \leq n$ and $x \neq a_i$)

$i := i + 1$

if $i \leq n$ **then** $location := i$

else $location := 0$

return $location$ { $location$ is the subscript of the term that equals x , or is 0 if x is not found}



Searching Algorithms (Contd.)

- ▶ **Binary Search:**
 - ▶ **INPUT:** A list of elements sorted in Ascending order.
 - ▶ **OUTPUT:** Index of the desired element in the list (if found).

ALGORITHM 3 The Binary Search Algorithm.

```
procedure binary search ( $x$ : integer,  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ : increasing integers)
 $i := 1$  { $i$  is left endpoint of search interval}
 $j := n$  { $j$  is right endpoint of search interval}
while  $i < j$ 
     $m := \lfloor (i + j)/2 \rfloor$ 
    if  $x > a_m$  then  $i := m + 1$ 
    else  $j := m$ 
if  $x = a_i$  then  $location := i$ 
else  $location := 0$ 
return  $location$  { $location$  is the subscript  $i$  of the term  $a_i$  equal to  $x$ , or 0 if  $x$  is not found}
```



Sorting Algorithms (Contd.)

- ▶ The task of ordering elements from an unordered list, in ascending or descending order.
 - ▶ For instance, sorting in ascending order, the list 7, 2, 1, 4, 5, 9 produces the list 1, 2, 4, 5, 7, 9 and the list *d, h, c, a, f* (using alphabetical order) produces the list *a, c, d, f, h*.
- ▶ **Sorting Algorithms:**
 - ▶ Bubble Sort
 - ▶ Insertion Sort



Sorting Algorithms (Contd.)

- ▶ **Bubble Sort:**
 - ▶ **INPUT:** An unsorted list of elements.
 - ▶ **OUTPUT:** A sorted list of elements in ascending(or descending) order.
 - ▶ Smaller Elements “*bubble*” to the top while the Larger Elements “*sink*” to the bottom.
 - ▶ Simplest but not the most efficient one.

ALGORITHM 4 The Bubble Sort.

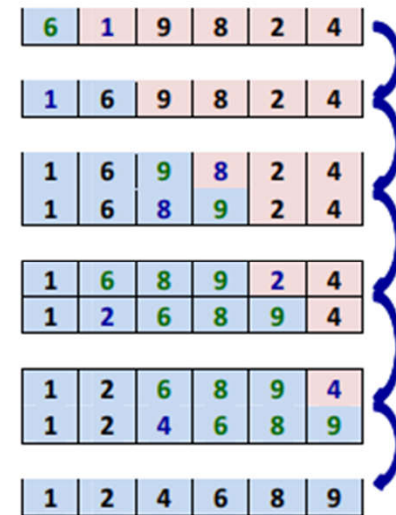
```
procedure bubblesort( $a_1, \dots, a_n$  : real numbers with  $n \geq 2$ )  
for  $i := 1$  to  $n - 1$   
    for  $j := 1$  to  $n - i$   
        if  $a_j > a_{j+1}$  then interchange  $a_j$  and  $a_{j+1}$   
{ $a_1, \dots, a_n$  is in increasing order}
```


Sorting Algorithms (Contd.)

- ▶ **Insertion Sort:**
 - ▶ **INPUT:** An unsorted list of elements.
 - ▶ **OUTPUT:** A sorted list of elements in ascending (or descending) order.
 - ▶ Simple but usually not the most efficient one.

ALGORITHM 5 The Insertion Sort.

```
procedure insertion sort( $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ : real numbers with  $n \geq 2$ )  
for  $j := 2$  to  $n$   
     $i := 1$   
    while  $a_j > a_i$   
         $i := i + 1$   
     $m := a_j$   
    for  $k := 0$  to  $j - i - 1$   
         $a_{j-k} := a_{j-k-1}$   
     $a_i := m$   
{ $a_1, \dots, a_n$  is in increasing order}
```



Greedy Algorithms

- ▶ Selects the best option instead of considering all possible options that may lead to an optimal solution.
- ▶ Once known, that a *Greedy Algorithm* finds a feasible solution, it is necessary to determine optimality of the solution.



Greedy Algorithms(Contd.)

▶ Example 5:

Consider the problem of making n cents change with *quarters*(25), *dimes*(10), *nickels*(5), and *pennies*(1), and using the *least total number* of coins.

▶ Solution:

We can devise a greedy algorithm for making change for n cents by making a locally optimal choice at each step; that is, at each step we choose the coin of the largest denomination possible to add to the pile of change without exceeding n cents.

- ▶ For example, to make change for 67 *cents*, we first select a *quarter* (leaving 42 *cents*). We next select a second quarter (leaving 17 *cents*), followed by a *dime* (leaving 7 *cents*), followed by a *nickel* (leaving 2 *cents*), followed by a *penny* (leaving 1 *cent*), followed by 1 *penny*.



Greedy Algorithms(Contd.)

ALGORITHM 6 Greedy Change-Making Algorithm.

procedure *change*($c_1, c_2, \dots, c_r$: values of denominations of coins, where
 $c_1 > c_2 > \dots > c_r$; n : a positive integer)
for $i := 1$ **to** r
 $d_i := 0$ { d_i counts the coins of denomination c_i used}
 while $n \geq c_i$
 $d_i := d_i + 1$ {add a coin of denomination c_i }
 $n := n - c_i$
{ d_i is the number of coins of denomination c_i in the change for $i = 1, 2, \dots, r$ }

The Halting Problem

- ▶ **Problem Statement:**

- ▶ *Is there any procedure that takes as input*

- ▶ *A computer program and*

- ▶ *Input to the program*

- and determines whether the program will eventually stop when run with this input?*



The Halting Problem(Contd.)

- ▶ Discussion:

- ▶ Consider a procedure $H(P, I)$ with the following:

- ▶ **INPUT:** P as a *procedure* and I as the *input* to the procedure P .

- ▶ **OUTPUT:**

$$H(P, I) = \begin{cases} \text{"Halts"} & , \text{if } P \text{ stops with input } I \\ \text{"Loops Forever"} & , \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

- ▶ **POINT to be noted!!!:**

- ▶ When a procedure is coded, it is expressed as a string of characters, which can be interpreted as a sequence of bits. Meaning, the procedure itself can be interpreted as an **INPUT**. Thus, it is safe to assume that, H can take the procedure P as both of its parameters, i.e. $H(P, P)$ is possible.



The Halting Problem(Contd.)

- ▶ Consider another procedure $K(P)$ with the following:

- ▶ **INPUT:** The output of $H(P, P)$ which is either “Halts” or “Loops Forever”.

- ▶ **OUTPUT:**

$$K(P) = \begin{cases} \text{“Halts”} & , \text{if } H(P, P) \text{ outputs “Loops Forever”} \\ \text{“Loos Forever”} & , \text{if } H(P, P) \text{ outputs “Halts”} \end{cases}$$

i.e. $K(P)$ specifies the opposite of whatever $H(P, P)$ gives as output.

- ▶ With all these definitions in mind, let us now consider $H(K, K)$, i.e. K itself becomes the **INPUT** to H and H will determine whether K “Halts” or “Loops Forever”.



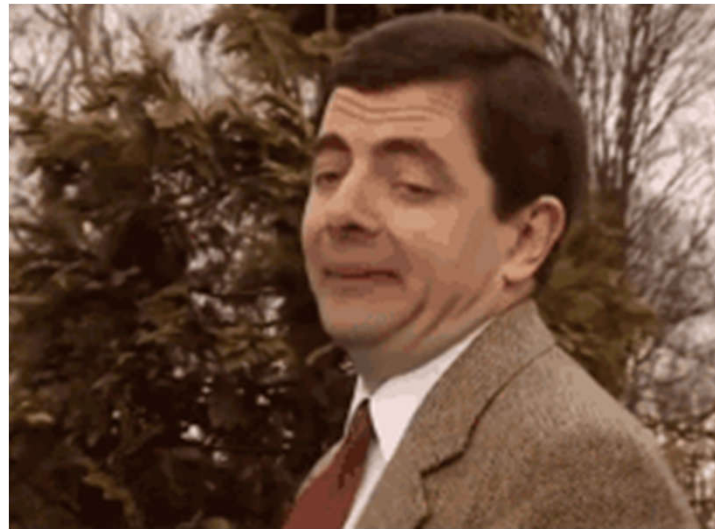
The Halting Problem(Contd.)

- ▶ So, for K to give an output, it first needs to know the output of H .
 - ▶ If $OUTPUT(H(K, K)) = K$ "Halts", then $OUTPUT(K(K)) = K$ "Loops Forever".
 - ▶ If $OUTPUT(H(K, K)) = K$ "Loops Forever", then $OUTPUT(K(K)) = K$ "Halts".



The Halting Problem(Contd.)

► **We knew that was easy!!!!**



The Halting Problem(Contd.)

► Wait.....WHAT!!!!!!??????



The Halting Problem(Contd.)

- ▶ THIS IS NOT POSSIBLE!!!
- ▶ *K* cannot "*Halt*" and "*Loop Forever*" AT THE SAME TIME!!!
- ▶ Clearly this is a contradiction!!!
- ▶ Thus, we can conclude,
"*The Halting Problem* is *UNSOLVABLE*" – courtesy of Alan Turing.



The Halting Problem(Contd.)

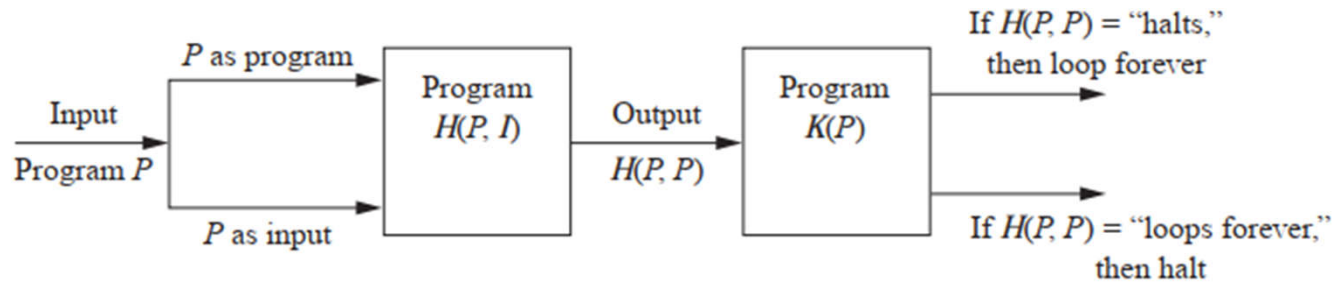


FIGURE 2 Showing that the Halting Problem is Unsolvable.



THE END

